A quiet-race tie on position. The hard start is 5.2 seconds quicker.

Simulated finishing positions from a pit-lane start: 53 laps, 22 cars; 22s pit loss, 11s under the Safety Car. Hard degradation: 0.015s/lap.
A and B both finish P3 without a Safety Car. Early or mid-race neutralisation hurts the lap-one stop; the conventional plan finishes P8 throughout.

	no safety car	SC lap 1	SC lap 5	SC lap 20	SC lap 35
Box lap 1 hard to the flag	**P3** +14.9s to the winner	**P8** +28.4s to the winner	**P8** +27.0s to the winner	**P8** +20.0s to the winner	**P3** +7.3s to the winner
Start hard, go long medium at lap 36	**P3** +9.7s to the winner	**P3** +18.6s to the winner	**P10** +39.7s to the winner	**P3** +15.0s to the winner	**P1** +0.0s to the winner
Conventional medium, stop lap 20, hard	**P8** +30.2s to the winner	**P8** +28.4s to the winner	**P8** +27.0s to the winner	**P8** +19.8s to the winner	**P8** +12.5s to the winner

FINISHING-POSITION BANDS P1 · P2–P6 · P7–P8 · P9+

Independent reconstruction · Not a validated forecast

Baseline: hard 0.015s/lap, medium 0.05, soft 0.10; medium and soft are 0.20s and 0.35s quicker than a new hard. Fuel effect: 0.07s/lap.
Dirty air costs 0.25s/lap within 2s; passing requires a 0.35s/lap advantage and time crossing. Safety Car: one shared, fixed-duration window.
Source: saved project baseline results (antonelli_15_scenarios.csv). Gaps are to each scenario's own winner, rounded to 0.1s. Layout inspired by Ruth Buscombe's briefing.